Another feature PactFlow offers that could help sell contract testing to teams is the support for the additional contract type of OpenAPI specification. Teams with existing OpenAPI specifications can therefore use existing tools and frameworks. We'll elaborate on this more in chapter 11 on bi-directional contract testing (another feature only supported by PactFlow).

Summary

- The purpose of Pact Broker is to share contracts, monitor contract changes, help coordinate releases, and integrate into CI/CD pipelines.
- Pact Broker core features, such as the matrix and network diagram, help visualize contract changes in a simple way.
- PactFlow provides additional features on Pact Broker, such as API tokens and user management to improve security.
- PactFlow contract stub feature means it can be used within an end-to-end test framework to improve validity.
- Contracts are published to the broker using the Pact Broker CLI, providing an easy way to integrate with CI/CD solutions.
- Pact Broker can be dockerized and deployed with Kubernetes, offering an easy way to self-host the broker.
- SaaS provides stability and features that seamlessly integrate with developer tools, whereas self-hosting Pact Broker provides flexibility and low costs for the core functionality.